36. Shere (1951).

37. Gupta (1980): 55–9.

38. In later sources Kautilya is sometimes known by other names: Vishnugupta and Chanakya. The *Arthashastra*'s first chapter mentions towards the end that the 'shastta' was composed by Kautilya. In the colophons at the end of the various books as well, that is was composed by Kautilya is also mentioned.

39. Shamasastry cites several such sources such as the *Vishnupurana*, Kamandaka's *Nitisara*, Dandin's *Dasakumaracarita* and the *Panchatantra*. Importantly, as he pointed out, these mention the Mauryas and the nature of this text when they allude to the author of the *Arthashastra*. The *Vishupurana*, for instance, noted that '(First) Mahapadma; then his sons, only nine in number, will be the lords of the earth for a hundred years. Those Nandas Kautilya, a Brahman, will slay. On their death, the Mauryas will enjoy the earth. Kautilya himself will install Chandragupta on their throne. His son will be Bindusara, and his son Asokavardhana.' The author of the *Panchatantra* ascribed the text to the author in this way: 'Then the Dharma - sastras are those of Manu and others, the Arthasastras of Chanakya and others, the Kama Sutras of Vatsyayana and others'. See Shamasastry (1915): vii–viii.

40. See Shamasastry (1915).

41. For details, see Kangle (1969): pt I, xi–xviii.

42. The *Arthashastra* has been used for writing on different aspects of Mauryan times by Sastri (1967), Thapar (1961), and Singh (2009), among others. Even Trautmann, who has pointed out the possibility of multiple authors for different parts of the text, has no hesitation in using it as a source for his work on elephants and the Mauryas (1982). For an early discussion on the controversy, Kangle (1965): pt III, ch. 4.

43. Olivelle (2013): 9–25.

44. An example of this is the importance that Olivelle gives to allusions to coral—which he believes to be Mediterranean coral—in the *Arthashastra*. Trade with the Mediterranean, he argues, could not have been flourishing before the first century BCE, which would be the earliest date for Kautilya to mention coral. Actually, if we look at the archaeological evidence for coral in India, it is present much before the first century BCE. Coral, in fact, has a long history of usage going back to the time of the Indus civilization when it is present, for instance, at Harappa. Again, in the second